

Practice sheet: Chapter 1, Circuit Variables

This sheet is not marked for correctness, and AI tools are allowed. Next session's device-free quiz is built from twins of these questions, so make sure you can do each one on your own.

- **Two-tier items** ask for an answer *and* a reason. Both must be right.
- **Predict first:** where asked, write your prediction before you calculate.
- **Confidence:** next to each answer, write S (sure) or U (unsure). This is not marked; it shows you what to revise.
- **Passive sign convention:** $p > 0$ means the element absorbs power; $p < 0$ means it delivers power.

S1. Prefixes. A sensor's output current is 0.000047 A. Which is the way engineers write it, with the prefix chosen so the number lies between 1 and 1000?

- a) 0.047 mA b) 47 μ A
c) 47 nA d) 4.7×10^{-5} mA

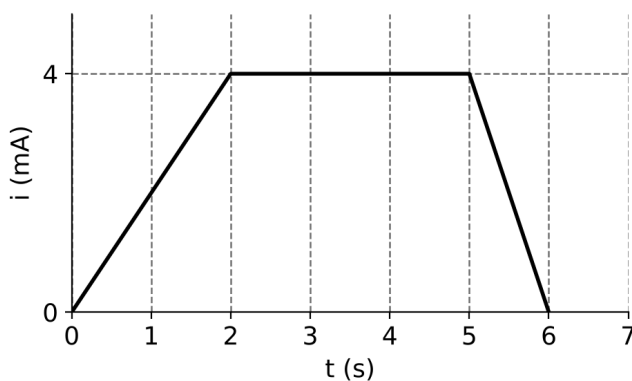
S2. Your generator subscription (two-tier). Your home has a 5 A generator subscription at 220 V. Treat each rating as the power the appliance draws: kettle 2000 W, washing machine 500 W, heater fan 300 W, fridge 150 W, TV 100 W, laptop 65 W, all LED lights together 60 W. Which set can run at the same time without tripping the breaker?

- a) Kettle and LED lights
- b) Washing machine, heater fan, fridge, TV, laptop and LED lights
- c) Washing machine, fridge, TV, laptop and LED lights
- d) Kettle alone

Reason:

- i) The subscription limits energy per month, so any set works if used briefly.
- ii) The subscription limits power, $P = VI = 1100 \text{ W}$ at any moment.
- iii) The subscription limits current, so the voltage does not matter.
- iv) Only the largest appliance counts.

S3. Charge from a current graph. The graph shows the current entering an element (zero outside the times shown).



Predict first: is the total charge more or less than $4 \text{ mA} \times 6 \text{ s} = 24 \text{ mC}$? Why?

How much charge enters the element in total?

- a) 24 mC b) 16 mC
c) 22 mC d) 18 mC

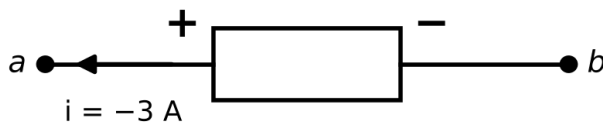
S4. Current from charge (two-tier). The charge entering an element is $q(t) = 4(1 - e^{-250t})$ mC for $t \geq 0$, and zero before. What is the current at $t = 0^+$?

- a) 0
- b) 4 mA
- c) 1 A
- d) 250 mA

Reason:

- i) $q(0) = 0$, so $i(0) = 0$.
- ii) Current is the charge divided by the time.
- iii) Current is the slope dq/dt , which is largest at $t = 0$.
- iv) Current is the final charge, 4 mC, per second.

S5. What a negative current means (two-tier).



Through the element, positive charge actually flows:

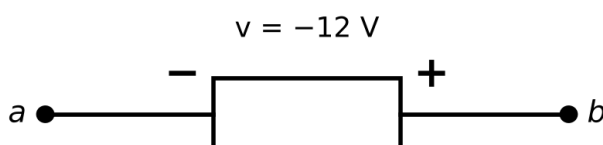
- a) from a to b
- b) from b to a
- c) nowhere, because a negative current means no flow
- d) cannot tell without the voltage

Reason:

- i) The arrow is only a reference; a negative value means the flow is opposite to the arrow.
- ii) A negative current means electrons flow instead of charge.
- iii) Current always flows from + to —.
- iv) The arrow shows the true direction, whatever the sign.

Follow-up: in which direction do the electrons move?

S6. What a negative voltage means.

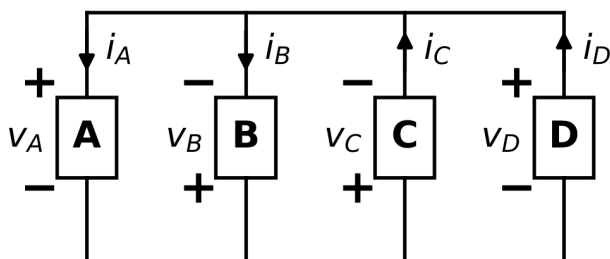


Which statement is true?

- a) Terminal b is 12 V higher than terminal a.
- b) Terminal a is 12 V higher than terminal b.
- c) Terminals a and b are at the same potential.
- d) The element must be delivering power.

S7. Predict, then compute. Four elements are connected between the same two wires. Their reference values are:

Element	A	B	C	D
v (V)	12	-12	-12	12
i (A)	3	-5	-4	2



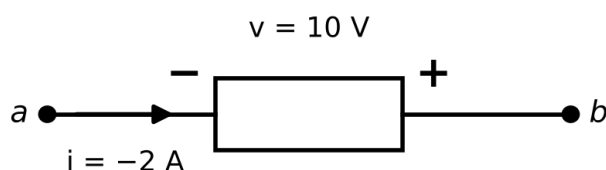
Predict first, with no numbers: for which elements does the reference arrow enter the + terminal?

Which elements absorb power?

- a) A and B
- b) B and D
- c) C and D
- d) A and C

Then find the total power delivered, and check that your four powers add up to zero.

S8. One element (two-tier).



The element:

- a) absorbs 20 W
- b) delivers 20 W
- c) absorbs 10 W
- d) delivers 40 W

Reason:

- i) The current arrow enters the - terminal, so $p = -vi$.
- ii) v and i have opposite signs, so p is negative.
- iii) Current flows into the element, so it absorbs.
- iv) v is positive, so it absorbs.

S9. Same element, different arrows (two-tier). Student X draws the current arrow into the + terminal of an element and finds $v = 5$ V, $i = 2$ A. Student Y analyses the same element but draws the current arrow the other way, keeping the same voltage polarity. What does Y get?

- a) $i = 2$ A, $p = -10$ W (delivered)
- b) $i = -2$ A, $p = -10$ W (delivered)
- c) $i = -2$ A, $p = 10$ W (absorbed)
- d) Y cannot get a valid answer with that arrow.

Reason:

- i) Reversing an arrow changes the sign of the number, not what the element physically does.
- ii) Reversing the arrow reverses the physical current.
- iii) Only arrows that enter the + terminal are allowed.
- iv) Power has no sign, so both get 10 W.

S10. Charging a battery. A 12 V car battery is charged at a constant 5 A for 2 h. How much energy is delivered to the battery?

- a) 120 J
- b) 7.2 kJ
- c) 432 kJ
- d) 432 J

Follow-up: write the same energy in kWh. While charging, does the charger current enter the battery's + or – terminal?

S11. Your power bank (two-tier). A power bank is rated 10,000 mAh at 3.7 V. It charges a phone through a 5 V, 3 A output. Ignoring losses, how long can it supply that output?

- a) 3.3 h
- b) 2.5 h
- c) 0.8 h
- d) 12.3 h

Reason:

- i) mAh measures charge; when the voltage changes, energy (Wh) is what carries over.
- ii) mAh measures energy, so the time is $10 \text{ Ah} \div 3 \text{ A}$.
- iii) The phone's voltage does not matter.
- iv) The time is the energy in Wh divided by the current in A.

S12. Energy from time-varying power. For $t \geq 0$, an element has $v = 50e^{-200t} \text{ V}$ and $i = 4e^{-200t} \text{ A}$, with the current entering the + terminal. What total energy is delivered to the element from $t = 0$ to ∞ ?

- a) 0.5 J
- b) 1 J
- c) 200 J
- d) 0.25 J

Hint: first write $p(t)$. How fast does p decay compared with v and i ?

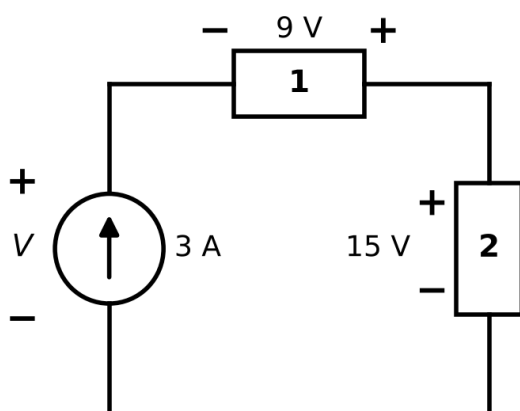
S13. Power balance (two-tier). A circuit has five elements. Using the passive sign convention, four of the powers are $p_1 = -60 \text{ W}$, $p_2 = +25 \text{ W}$, $p_3 = +18 \text{ W}$ and $p_4 = -8 \text{ W}$. What is p_5 ?

- a) 9 W absorbed
- b) 25 W delivered
- c) 111 W absorbed
- d) 25 W absorbed

Reason:

- i) The powers in a circuit add up to zero.
- ii) Only the delivered powers need to balance.
- iii) Absorbed power is always larger than delivered power.
- iv) p_5 is the sum of the other four.

S14. Spot the error. The worked solution below contains the kind of mistake AI chat tools most often make on circuit diagrams.



1. The 3 A source drives a clockwise current of 3 A through elements 1 and 2.
2. Element 1: $p_1 = (9)(3) = 27$ W, absorbed.
3. Element 2: the current enters the + terminal, so $p_2 = (15)(3) = 45$ W, absorbed.
4. KVL clockwise, drops positive:
 $-V - 9 + 15 = 0$, so $V = 6$ V.
5. Source: the current leaves its + terminal, so $p_s = -(6)(3) = -18$ W, delivered.
6. All powers have been found, so the solution is complete.

- a) Which is the first wrong line?
- b) Correct it.
- c) Do the power balance with the corrected values.
- d) Which line should have made you distrust this solution, and why?

S15. Work backwards. The current arrow of an element enters its + terminal and $i = 2$ A. What must v be for the element to *deliver* 30 W?

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|---------|----------|
| a) 15 V | b) -15 V |
| c) 60 V | d) -60 V |

S16. When does circuit theory apply? Use $\lambda = c/f$ with $c = 3 \times 10^8$ m/s and the one-tenth rule. Which systems can be analysed as lumped circuits?

- | | |
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| (i) a 30 km distribution feeder at 50 Hz | |
| (ii) a 10 cm Wi-Fi board at 2.4 GHz | |
| (iii) a 20 cm audio amplifier at 20 kHz | |
| a) (i) only | b) (i) and (iii) |
| c) all three | d) (ii) only |